Governor Newsom Signs $2.5 Billion Emergency Disaster Relief Bill to Aid Los Angeles County After Fire

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Funding Will Expedite Rebuilding, Support Schools, Protect Residents From Price Gouging

Governor Gavin Newsom joined local and state leaders near the fire-ravaged community of Altadena on Thursday to sign legislation providing more than $2.5 billion in disaster relief funding. The aid aims to expedite recovery efforts following the devastating Los Angeles hurricane-force firestorm and to support impacted residents, businesses, and schools.

The legislation, introduced in a special session as ABx1-4 by Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel (D-Encino) and SBx1-3 by Senator Scott Wiener (D-San Francisco), allocates funding for emergency response, rebuilding efforts, and restoring fire-damaged school facilities.

"Thanks to our partners in the legislature, we're providing over $2.5 billion in immediate relief—expediting initial firestorm response and recovery efforts," Newsom said. "Unlike MAGA Republicans in Washington, who talk about delaying relief for political purposes, California is supporting our people with no strings attached. Together, we'll rebuild Los Angeles."

The $2.5 billion package includes:

Senate President Pro Tempore Mike McGuire praised the rapid response, calling the funding a "down payment" on long-term recovery. "This $2.5 billion is a clear commitment that we've got your back, L.A.," McGuire said.

In addition to the legislation, Newsom has issued a series of executive orders to protect and assist those affected by the firestorm, including:

Newsom also issued orders to protect survivors from predatory real estate speculators and to expedite the return of displaced students to classrooms.

Senator Ben Allen, (D-Pacific Palisades), celebrated the passage of the bills, saying "The long road to recovery is just beginning, and these bills are a couple of important first steps to usher us along the path. Relief from these devastating fires is going to require a holistic approach, which will incorporate not just a massive financial undertaking, but a strong policy that ensures the best interests of victims and survivors are upheld through the rebuilding process as well. I am grateful to see this starting to come together, and am eager to see the money start flowing as quickly as possible to this community in dire need."

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